Tom Alvarez

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Product engineer with 2 years of full-stack development in React Native, TypeScript, Node.js and PostgreSQL, and a background managing subscription software products at Bloomsbury Publishing and Springer Nature. I build features end to end, from user research and requirements to tested, deployed code. Experienced in UX research, usability testing and WCAG accessibility. Native English, C1 Spanish and basic Galician.

SELECTED PROJECTS

pickup** (in alpha)* | React Native, Expo, TypeScript, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Tailwind, Jest ***2026

Took a sports meetup app from concept to alpha, owning the product and the build. Validated early assumptions with local players, then built it in React Native, Expo Router and TypeScript on Supabase, with a PostgreSQL schema, row-level security, invite-only access and a Jest test suite. Built with an AI coding agent, managing its context through project instructions.

https://pickup.tomalvarez.xyz

Personal Portfolio | React, CSS, Vite, API ***2025***

Designed and built a responsive single-page site to present my work clearly to different audiences, with accessible, semantic markup throughout, and language support for English, Spanish and Galician.

https://tomalvarez.xyz

Admin Dashboard | HTML, CSS, JavaScript, API ***2025***

Built a data-heavy admin interface from a Figma spec, prioritising the layout and information hierarchy a user would need to scan quickly, using CSS Grid and a component-based structure. Also implemented a third-party API.

https://brrrrdy.github.io/Dashboard

SKILLS

Technical Stack: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, REST APIs, OAuth, React Native, SQL/PostgreSQL, Supabase, CSS (Tailwind), XML, Git, Jest, GitHub Actions

Product & Process: Product spec development, user stories, roadmap ownership, agile/scrum, UAT, accessibility (WCAG)

UX & Analytics: User interviews, UX research studies, focus groups, A/B testing, card sorting, user-centred design, information architecture, taxonomy design, Axe, Lighthouse, wireframing & prototyping, usability testing, Figma, Axure, Google Analytics

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code in the terminal for agentic development; context engineering (CLAUDE.md and AGENTS.md project instructions, specifications, scoped context per task); LLM API integration (structured output, schema validation, evaluation test sets); ChatGPT, Gemini, Replit

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product and UX Specialist ***Freelance, UK and Spain (Hybrid) | Aug 2020–present***

Consulting and contract work in education, heritage and retail, including for the RIBA and AQA, to modernize digital delivery.

- Auditing complex content ecosystems and large academic databases, identifying opportunities to improve digital delivery, accessibility and information architecture.
- Undertaking UX studies and competitor analysis to inform product development and specification for new features.

UX Researcher ***Natural History Museum, London, UK | Feb 2020–March 2020***

Secured a highly competitive digital product research contract for the Urban Nature Project at the NHM, focusing on engagement strategies to inspire and inform its audiences in sustainability in urban areas, and to improve accessibility of its digital offering. Contract ended early following COVID-19 institutional closures.

English Teacher ***Freelance, Spain (Hybrid) | Dec. 2017–present***

Moved to Spain in 2017, originally taking a planned career break to teach and care for elderly relatives, and built this into a sustained freelance teaching practice across classroom, private and online settings.

Product Manager ***Bloomsbury Publishing, London, UK | Oct. 2016–Nov. 2017***

Held end-to-end product ownership of three digital subscription-based SaaS products for academic researchers and higher education institutions: Bloomsbury Popular Music, Bloomsbury Collections and Bloomsbury Architecture Library. Built Bloomsbury Popular Music from the ground up. and the platform later won a Choice Outstanding Academic Title award in Reference and Humanities (2019).

- Led products from discovery through release, translating user and business needs into prioritised requirements and coordinating engineering, editorial and commercial stakeholders to deliver new functionality.
- Used qualitative and quantitative research to shape product decisions, combining focus groups, A/B testing, card sorting and analytics to validate requirements, identify user needs and inform roadmap priorities.
- Improved product usability and discoverability for large and complex datasets through iterative wireframing, information architecture and taxonomy work, incorporating user-centred design and WCAG accessibility requirements, including screen reader and accessibility testing.
- Reduced delivery risk before release by completing UAT and working with stakeholders to identify, test and resolve issues before features reached users.
- Supported product strategy and commercial decision-making through market research and competitor analysis, helping stakeholders evaluate opportunities and prioritise product development.

Research Editor (Asst. Research Editor Jan 2014–15) ***Springer Nature, London, UK | Jan. 2014–Oct. 2016***

Progressed from Assistant Research Editor to Research Editor, working across editorial, product and technical teams to manage Springer Nature's flagship reference subscription products.

- Owned product management and lifecycle development of a new internal CMS for the global reference division, running organisation-wide UX research to support its rollout.
- Worked directly with external academics, authors and researchers to understand user needs, using that insight alongside market and competitor research to prioritise platform features.
- Coordinated editorial and technical production across content, design and technical teams to deliver digital and print solutions, including complementary graphical content.

Internships ***BBC, The Independent London, UK | 2011–2013***

EDUCATION & COURSES

B.A Philosophy & Ethics (2:1) ***King's College London | 2009–2012***

Full-stack web development ***Odin Project | 2024–2026***

Completed a rigorous, self-directed curriculum covering advanced JavaScript, React, Node.js, database architecture, and secure deployment pipelines.

Claude Code 101 ***Anthropic | Nov 2026***

Credential ID 7330da50d5cd9db6c7c378a6f5d1fc61

Fundamentals of User Experience and Interface Design ***WebCredible, London | 2016–2017***

Short courses on UX research methodologies, accessibility and interface design principles.